



A MURAL in East L.A. depicts Cesar Chavez on his namesake avenue. An old debate over the name returns.

Chavez scandal revives opposition to renaming Boyle Heights street

Inside Jesse's Barber Shop in Boyle Heights, Rodney Trammell gave an oral history of Brooklyn Avenue before it was renamed after civil rights leader Cesar E. Chavez.

The street, he recalled, was lined with Mexican and Jewish retail stores and bakeries. There was a movie theater and the original Canter's Deli opened here. Different nationalities and ethnic groups lived and shopped side by side.

Brooklyn Avenue, he said, *was* Boyle Heights.

So when civic leaders sought to rename it in 1993, many in the community were opposed. They were longtime residents and merchants: Jews, Mexicans and Mexican Americans.

In the '90s, many opposed renaming Brooklyn Avenue after labor leader

By Ruben Vives

The residents lost the battle but refused to accept it. They still refer to the street by its original name in conversations. Shopkeepers — new and old — bear the street name on their storefronts. Custom clothing designers and artists pay homage to it in hats, shirts and artwork.

"To me, it was always Brooklyn Avenue," Trammell said. "And it will always be Brooklyn Avenue."

Now amid talks of renaming the street in the wake of sex abuse allegations against the famed labor leader, the old debate has resurfaced, along with the conflicting emotions over it.

Chavez is accused of sexually assault-

[See Avenue, A8]

Tech backs Anthropic in standoff with the Pentagon

AI giant's battle with government rekindles previous resistance to war in Silicon Valley.

By Queenie Wong

Artificial intelligence powerhouse Anthropic's battle with the Pentagon has sparked some soul-searching in Silicon Valley that could reshape the tech sector's complicated relationship with war and the White House.

Anthropic is the San Francisco-based startup behind the chatbot Claude and some of the most powerful AI on the market. In its negotiations with the military, it has demanded guardrails on how its technology is used.

The military said it refused to be beholden to a corporation and pushed back, labeling Anthropic a threat akin to an enemy foreign power and blocking it from some government contracts.

Tech leaders have quietly backed Anthropic, saying that AI isn't ready for some weapons and that strong-arming companies is counterproductive and antidemocratic. President Trump called Anthropic a bunch of "left-wing nut jobs."

How this showdown plays out will affect not only Anthropic's booming business but also the way tech titans and other corporations work with an administration known for lashing out at resisters, said Alan Rozenshtein, an associate professor at the University of Minnesota Law School.

"On the one hand, it could cause the govern-

[See Anthropic, A12]

Gasoline price gouging in California draws a warning



ERIC THAYER Los Angeles Times

THE AVERAGE price of gas in California is \$5.66, but some stations were charging over \$9 as of Friday.

IRAN ATTACK: Strikes on communities near Israel's nuclear research site injure dozens. **WORLD, A3**

Finding ways to get groundwater back up

New research shows how some regions have halted declines in aquifer levels.

By Ian James

ARVIN, Calif. — In the southern San Joaquin Valley, where roads cut through thousands of acres of orange groves, grapevines and carrot fields, a canal reaches a linchpin that keeps the farming economy going: dozens of oblong ponds filled with shimmering water.

While many parts of California's Central Valley are struggling to counter widespread overpumping and declining underground water levels, the irrigation agency here is using the ponds to effectively swallow gulps of river water, getting it to seep into the soil and

recharge the groundwater.

"That sandy ground, when you put the water on it, it percolates into the groundwater and it recharges," said Jeevan Muhar, chief executive officer of Arvin-Edison Water Storage District. "So it's underneath us. We can see that water come up."

The irrigation district tracks groundwater levels. In dry times, when it needs to tap into stored water, it uses dozens of wells to pump it out and send it flowing to farms.

A new scientific study cites Arvin-Edison as one of dozens of areas where local efforts have managed to halt declines in water levels and allow aquifers to come back up.

"Unfortunately, groundwater is being depleted rapidly in many areas. However, groundwater depletion can be solved," said Scott

[See Groundwater, A10]

By Blanca Begert

California's petroleum market watchdog is warning about price gouging at some gas stations charging over \$7 or even \$8 a gallon as the Iran war sends oil prices soaring.

The average price of gas in California is currently \$5.66, but as of Friday, a Chevron station in Essex is charging \$9.69, another in Los Angeles' Chinatown is charging \$8.71, and one in Vidal Junction is charging \$7.79, according to GasBuddy, which tracks prices across the country.

"Our team is vigilantly

[See Gas, A4]

Trump plans for ICE at airports

Amid standoff, president urges Democrats to pass bill that would fund Homeland Security. **NATION, A6**

Quest for the three-peat opens

Manager Dave Roberts isn't letting the Dodgers overthink going for a third straight World Series championship. **SPORTS, D1**

Spring into new season of arts

A guide to the most anticipated events, the fight for live theater in L.A. and a call to save Gehry's ambitions. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather
Morning fog.
L.A. Basin: 81/58. **B8**

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Poll signals peril for Bass in reelection bid

She leads, but with only 25% against her little-known rivals in the L.A. mayor's race.

By Noah Goldberg

Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass has a lead over her challengers in her bid for reelection, but more than half of voters view her unfavorably, according to a poll released Sunday.

Bass was supported by 25% of voters, while City Councilmember Nithya Raman drew 17% and conservative reality TV star Spencer Pratt came in third at 14% in the poll by the UC Berkeley Institute of Governmental Studies, co-sponsored by The Times.

About a quarter of voters were undecided, the poll found.

Bass has come under heavy criticism for her handling of the devastating Palisades fire. More than a year later, 56% of those polled said they had an unfavorable

view of her, while 31% viewed her favorably.

The survey of 840 likely voters between March 9 and 15 provides one of the first snapshots of the mayoral race, less than three months before the June 2 primary.

Beyond the top three, leftist Rae Huang notched support from 8% of those polled, while tech entrepreneur Adam Miller drew 6%.

Despite Bass' lead, the poll is "borderline catastrophic" for her, because the field of candidates is so weak, said Dan Schnur, a politics professor at USC, UC Berkeley and Pepperdine.

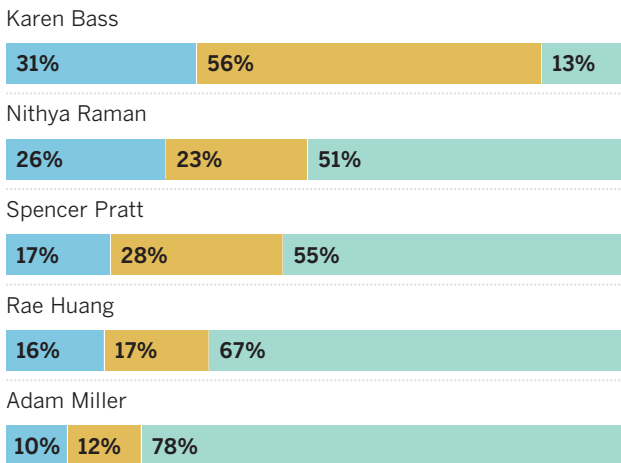
"That she's having this much trouble against this field, against such a little-known field of opponents, bodes very, very poorly for her," Schnur said. "The only thing saving her at this point is that the top tier of potential candidates who were considering running against her decided to stay out of this race."

The mayoral race solidified in early February, when

[See Mayor's race, A10]

More than half of likely voters view Bass unfavorably and have no opinion of other candidates

Favorable Unfavorable No Opinion



Berkeley IGS Poll conducted online March 9-15, 2026, among 840 Los Angeles city likely voters.
GABRIELLE LAMARR LEMEE Los Angeles Times

Former FBI Director Robert Mueller dies

He transformed the agency after 9/11 and led the Russia probe of Trump, who says: 'I'm glad he's dead.'

By Eric Tucker

WASHINGTON — Robert S. Mueller III, the FBI director who transformed the nation's premier law enforcement agency into a terrorism-fighting force after the Sept. 11, 2001, attacks and later became special counsel in charge of investigating ties between Russia and Donald Trump's presidential campaign, has died. He was 81.

"With deep sadness, we are sharing the news that Bob passed away" on Friday

night, his family said in a statement Saturday. "His family asks that their privacy be respected."

President Trump, responding on social media, said: "Robert Mueller just died. Good, I'm glad he's dead." He added: "He can no longer hurt innocent people!"

At the FBI, Mueller set about almost immediately overhauling the bureau's mission to meet the law enforcement needs of the 21st century, beginning his 12-year tenure just one week before the Sept. 11 attacks and serving across presidents of both political parties. He was nominated by Republican President George W. Bush.

The cataclysmic event instantaneously switched the bureau's top priority from

[See Mueller, A7]



SUSAN WALSH Associated Press

SPECIAL COUNSEL Robert S. Mueller III appears before the House Judiciary Committee in July 2019.